

Do English with Brian

Class 01 · Academic Conference English

IAS 2026 Preparation

Small Talk · Research Presentation · Q&A

2 Hours | 1:1 | Sports Medicine · PhD Researcher

Today's Class Structure — 2 Hours

PART 01

~20 min

Introduction

Let's get to know
each other &
our approach

PART 02

~30 min

Warm-Up

Level check &
research intro
Korean → English

PART 03

~50 min

Conference Small Talk

Situation-based
expressions
+ Role play A·B·C

PART 04

~10 min

Elevator Pitch

30-second
research intro
template

PART 05

~10 min

Q&A Sampler

3 key patterns
+ feedback &
next class
preview

Part 01 — Let's Get to Know Each Other

Before we dive in — a few questions to get the conversation started.

1. What stage are you at with your PhD right now?

Where in the journey

Brian asks

2. Have you presented at an international conference before?

Experience level check

Brian asks

3. What does IAS 2026 mean to you — is it your first big international stage?

Stakes & motivation

Brian asks

4. What feels most uncomfortable — presenting, Q&A, or just talking to people?

Identify the focus area

Brian asks

5. Outside of research, what do you enjoy doing?

Build rapport — helps with small talk later

Brian asks

Part 01 — Our Teaching Approach



All English, all the time

The entire class runs in English. When something is unclear, we work through it in English — not by switching to Korean. This builds real fluency.



Upgraded expressions, not corrections

Instead of pointing out mistakes, we'll show you a more natural way to say the same thing. Small upgrades, big difference.



Confidence first, perfection later

The goal isn't flawless grammar. It's being able to hold your own in a room full of international researchers.



Role play is the core

Most learning happens through doing. We'll simulate real conference situations — you talk, Brian responds, we adjust.



Your research, your words

Everything we practice will be grounded in your actual work. You won't memorize generic sentences — you'll build your own.

Part 02 — Warm-Up: Let's Hear from You

Speak freely — there are no wrong answers here. Just talk.

1. Tell me about your research — in Korean first, then we'll work on the English together.

Korean → English

2. When you imagine being at IAS 2026, which moment feels most daunting?

Brian asks

3. What feels most uncomfortable right now — presenting, Q&A, or just talking to people?

Brian asks

4. Have you ever tried explaining your research in English before? How did it go?

Brian asks

Flow: Jiyeon explains in Korean -> Brian listens -> Brian reflects back in natural English -> Jiyeon repeats

Part 03 — Conference Small Talk: Questions First

You don't have to introduce yourself first. Ask a question — they talk, you think, conversation flows.

Key insight: When you ask a genuine question, the other person talks — and you get time to think about what to say next.

After a talk

That was a really interesting talk — I hadn't thought about it from that angle before.

Compliment → no pressure to introduce yourself yet

At a poster

I was just reading your poster — what made you choose this population?

Specific question → shows you're engaged, not just being polite

First meeting

Is this your first time at IAS, or have you been before?

Simple, open-ended → easy for them to answer

Common ground

I work with CAI patients as well — are you finding similar patterns?

Shared topic → instant connection

Workshop/break

Have you applied this clinically yet, or is it still more research-based?

Shows depth of interest → moves past surface chat

Part 03 — Role Play: 3 Conference Scenarios

Roles

Brian = International researcher attending IAS 2026

Jiyoona = PhD researcher — presenting her study on foot core vs trunk core training in CAI

Today's Scenarios

Scenario A • Coffee Break

Jiyoona initiates a conversation with a researcher she hasn't met.

Scenario B • Poster Session

A researcher stops at Jiyoona's poster and asks about her study.

Scenario C • After a Keynote

Both attended the same talk — natural common ground to open with.

How it works

Jiyoona initiates or responds -> Brian reacts naturally -> Brian corrects + suggests upgrade -> Jiyoona tries again

Scenario A — Coffee Break



Situation

학회 첫날 오전 세션 후 커피 브레이크 . Brian 이 혼자 커피를 들고 서 있습니다 . Jiyeon 이 먼저 말을 걸거나 , Brian 이 자연스럽게 합류하는 상황 .

Useful Expressions

Opening

"Is this your first time at IAS, or have you been before?"

Finding common ground

"What's your background — are you more on the clinical or research side?"

Bringing up the talks

"Have you had a chance to catch any of the talks yet? Anything stand out?"

Introducing yourself

"I work in ankle instability — actually presenting here myself."

Role Play Flow

1

Brian standing nearby with coffee

2

Jiyeon opens with a question

3

Exchange backgrounds naturally

4

Research topics come up

Remember: You don't need to be perfect — you need to keep the conversation going.

Scenario B — Poster Session

Situation

Jiyeon 이 본인 포스터 앞에 서 있고 , Brian 이 관심 있게 포스터를 읽다가 질문을 하는 상황 . 연구를 자연스럽게 설명하는 가장 중요한 장면입니다 .

Useful Expressions

Opening the walkthrough

"Happy to walk you through it — the main question we were asking was..."

Background

"People with CAI show deficits in both foot and trunk core — but no one had directly compared the two."

Findings

"Both interventions helped, but foot core training showed earlier improvements in postural stability."

Inviting questions

"Does that make sense? Happy to go into more detail on any part."

Role Play Flow

1

Brian reads the poster

2

Brian asks: 'Can you tell me about this?'

3

Jiyeon walks through the study

4

Brian asks 2~3 questions

Remember: You don't need to be perfect — you need to keep the conversation going.

Scenario C — After a Keynote



Situation

같은 키노트를 들은 후 복도나 로비에서 자연스럽게 마주친 상황 . 공통된 경험이 있어서 1 성향인 분도 훨씬 편하게 시작할 수 있는 상황입니다 .

Useful Expressions

Opening

"That was a really interesting talk — I hadn't thought about it from that angle."

Sharing a take

"The point about proximal stability was particularly interesting — it connects to what I'm researching."

Bridging to your work

"I'm looking at something similar — comparing foot core and trunk core training in CAI patients."

Asking their opinion

"Did the findings align with what you're seeing in your work?"

Role Play Flow

1

Cross paths in the hallway/lobby

2

Jiyeon comments on the keynote

3

Share perspectives on the topic

4

Bridge naturally to own research

Remember: You don't need to be perfect — you need to keep the conversation going.

Part 04 — 30-Second Elevator Pitch

When someone asks 'What's your research about?' — you need a clear, confident answer. Not a lecture.

Template — Build Your Own Version

TOPIC

"I'm looking at chronic ankle instability..."

THE GAP

"...specifically, no one had directly compared whether foot core or trunk core training is more effective for postural control."

WHAT YOU DID

"So we ran a randomized trial — 21 participants across three groups, foot core, trunk core, and control."

KEY FINDING

"Both helped, but foot core training showed earlier improvements in postural stability and muscle morphology."

WHY IT MATTERS

"The idea is to help clinicians know which intervention to prioritize for different patients."

Part 05 — Q&A Sampler: 3 Patterns to Know

You don't need to know everything. You need to handle the moment gracefully.

01

Buying
time

When: You need a moment to think

-
>

"That's a great point — let me think about that for a second."

-
>

"That's an interesting question — can I just clarify what you mean by...?"

02

When
you don't
know

When: The question is outside your scope

-
>

"That's outside the scope of what we looked at, but it's a really interesting direction."

-
>

"Honestly, that's something I'd like to explore in future work — we didn't have the power to address that here."

03

Confirmi
ng the
question

When: You're not sure what they're asking

-
>

"Just to make sure I'm understanding your question correctly — are you asking about...?"

-
>

"So if I'm hearing you right, your concern is...? Is that right?"

Today's Key Expressions

1. Is this your first time at IAS, or have you been before?

3. I work with CAI patients as well — are you seeing similar patterns?

5. Happy to walk you through it — the main question we were asking was...

7. The point about proximal stability connects to what I'm researching.

9. That's a great point — let me think about that for a second.

11. Just to make sure I'm understanding — are you asking about...?

2. Have you had a chance to catch any of the talks yet?

4. That was a really interesting talk — I hadn't thought about it from that angle.

6. Both helped, but foot core showed earlier improvements in postural stability.

8. I'd love to hear more about your work — are you presenting here?

10. That's outside the scope of what we looked at, but really interesting.

12. So if I'm hearing you right, your concern is...?

Great work today! Expressions will be shared via KakaoTalk.